

Alchemy: A Formal Theory of Consciousness, Embodiment, and Materialization

Daniel Ray Edgar

July 2026

Abstract

Alchemy is usually treated as a failed chemistry or a spiritual metaphor. This paper recovers its deeper structure as a theory of human causation. A person can hold a form that does not yet exist, organize the body and identity around that form, act from it, and stabilize its consequences in the physical world. Alchemy is therefore defined as the disciplined process by which an imaginal form is embodied, enacted, and made material.

The theory joins three realms. The imaginal realm contains goals, symbols, identities, and models of possible futures. The embodied realm contains attention, expectation, physiology, skill, and action readiness. The material realm contains observable artifacts, relationships, institutions, and environments. Their causal order is formalized as

$$\text{form} \rightarrow \text{embodiment} \rightarrow \text{policy} \rightarrow \text{action} \rightarrow \text{world change} \rightarrow \text{feedback}.$$

Within this model, four results are proved. A vision cannot change an external outcome unless some mediator changes. A more capable embodied state can enlarge the set of reachable futures. Repeated identity-consistent action makes an enacted identity converge toward a target identity under a simple update rule. Directed repetition increases the cumulative probability of material success.

Evidence from imagery, implementation intentions, placebo physiology, identity, habit, bioelectric signaling, sleep, hydration, inflammation, nutrition, attention, and contemplative practice supports the mediating links. Hermetic alchemy, kundalini, theosis, Christ consciousness, and sacred-secretion traditions are interpreted as symbolic maps of transformation rather than interchangeable anatomical claims. The 1983 Army Gateway memorandum is examined as technological alchemy: an effort to operationalize altered-state disciplines through audio, feedback, rehearsal, and staged practice. U.S. Patent 6,506,148 is examined as a genuine technical claim whose legal grant does not substitute for independent replication.

The conclusion is direct. Consciousness does not materialize a desired reality by escaping causality. It materializes reality by entering causality through a trained body, a coherent identity, repeated action, and correction by evidence. Human beings are alchemical because they can become organized by a future that exists first as form, then make that form physically consequential.

1 Alchemy Is the Human Operation

Every deliberately created human reality exists first as a form. A building begins as a drawing. A company begins as a model of an institution that has not yet opened. A scientific paper begins as an argument without pages. A changed life begins as an image of a person whose habits, relationships, and works do not yet fully exist. Matter is not rearranged by the image alone, but the rearrangement would not occur in that form without the image.

This passage is the central human operation. Consciousness can represent what is absent. The body can organize itself around that representation. Action can carry the representation into shared space. Feedback can correct the difference between the desired form and the world. The process is ancient, ordinary, and profound.

Definition 1.1 (Alchemy). Alchemy is the disciplined process by which an imaginal form is embodied, enacted, and stabilized as material reality.

The definition has six verbs:

solve $\rightarrow$ form $\rightarrow$ embody $\rightarrow$ enact $\rightarrow$ coagulate $\rightarrow$ assay.

Solve dissolves an inherited pattern. *Form* specifies the reality to be created. *Embody* prepares the biological and psychological vessel. *Enact* applies force through behavior. *Coagulate* stabilizes the result in matter, relationship, or institution. *Assay* tests the work against reality. The assay then begins another cycle.

This theory accepts a strong claim and rejects an unnecessary one. The strong claim is that consciousness participates in producing reality. The unnecessary claim is that thought must rearrange distant matter without a mediator. A human being is already inside the causal order. Attention changes sampling. Expectation changes preparation and, in bounded settings, physiology. Identity changes action readiness. Action changes objects and other people. Repetition changes skill, habit, and reputation. These are not weak substitutes for magic. They are the actual means by which a private future acquires public form.

Manifestation is therefore not passive wishing. It is alchemical materialization:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{imaginal form} &\longrightarrow \text{embodied state} \longrightarrow \text{selected policy} \\ &\longrightarrow \text{physical action} \longrightarrow \text{material consequence.} \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

Each link is necessary under the ordinary causal model. Form without embodiment is fantasy. Embodiment without direction is unused capacity. Intention without policy is a wish. Policy without action remains private. Action without feedback becomes blind repetition. The complete loop is the Great Work.

This formulation also clarifies freedom. Reality is not fixed because present choices change the distribution of later states. Reality is not infinitely compliant because material constraints, chance, time, other agents, and prior conditions remain real. Alchemy operates between fatalism and omnipotence. It is the art of increasing the probability that a chosen form becomes a lived fact.

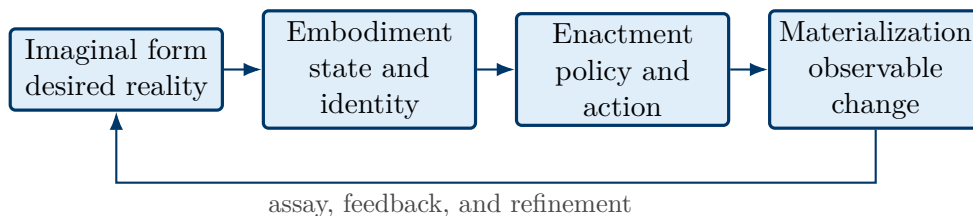


Figure 1: The alchemical loop. A represented future becomes causally effective through embodiment and action, then returns as evidence.

2 The Three Realms

Alchemy requires clear terms for the reality being transformed. The language of mental, astral, and physical planes is meaningful only if the levels are distinguished. This paper uses three realms.

Definition 2.1 (Imaginal realm). The imaginal realm is the set of forms an agent can represent: images, concepts, symbols, goals, counterfactuals, memories, identities, and models of possible futures.

Definition 2.2 (Embodied realm). The embodied realm is the agent’s present capacity to perceive, regulate, decide, learn, and act. It includes attention, expectation, emotion, physiology, skill, identity, and action readiness.

Definition 2.3 (Material realm). The material realm is the observable world in which actions have consequences: bodies, objects, documents, money, relationships, institutions, and environments.

The imaginal realm is not unreal. Every represented future is instantiated in a living system before its object exists. It can guide perception and action while remaining distinct from the world it represents. The imagined house is not yet shelter. The imagined company cannot yet employ anyone. The represented future is a causal form, not a finished object.

The traditional astral image can be understood as an especially vivid form in the imaginal realm. It may be experienced as a scene, journey, presence, or symbolic world with unusual emotional force. Reports of mystical and self-transcendent experience are real objects of psychological study [James, 1902, Yaden et al., 2017]. This paper does not need to settle whether an independent astral substance exists. It asks the operational question: does the experience change the person who returns to action?

That question separates productive imagination from dissociation. A productive image increases contact with reality. It clarifies a target, reveals a conflict, rehearses a response, or makes a value actionable. An unproductive image becomes a substitute for evidence. The difference is not vividness. The difference is whether the image enters the full loop of embodiment, action, and assay.

The relation among realms is asymmetric. A material condition can alter embodiment: sleep loss changes attention, and an unsafe room changes action readiness. Embodiment can alter which forms are available: panic narrows imagination, while skill reveals possibilities

a novice cannot yet see. An imaginal form can alter embodiment by changing attention, expectation, and preparation. The realms continuously constrain and update one another.

The word *descent* is therefore appropriate when used precisely. A form descends from imagination into matter as it acquires more constraints. An idea has many possible expressions. A plan excludes some of them. A practiced policy excludes more. A completed artifact is one expression fixed in material. Materialization is not a fall from a superior unreal world. It is the progressive determination of possibility into observable form.

3 The Human Vessel

The human body is not a container carrying a separate mind. It is part of the intelligence that must perform the work. Neurons use electrical and chemical signaling. Cells maintain membrane potentials. Tissues communicate through chemical, mechanical, and bioelectric channels. Bioelectric patterns participate in development, regeneration, and large-scale anatomical organization [Levin, 2021, Durant et al., 2019]. The body is therefore an electrochemical information-processing organism.

That statement is powerful without being inflated. The body is not a digital computer with one agreed global bit rate. A membrane voltage is not a thought, and a measurable field is not automatically a semantic broadcast. Estimates of human information throughput depend on what is being counted, from cellular signaling to consciously reportable behavior [Kandel et al., 2021, Zheng and Meister, 2025, Sauerbrei and Pruszyński, 2025]. Precision strengthens the thesis because the genuine biology is already remarkable.

Attention, rehearsal, and expectation

An imaginal form enters the vessel through known mechanisms. First, it changes relevance. No nervous system can process every available signal. A clearly represented goal changes which cues are noticed, remembered, and retrieved. This is not the universe sending a personal sign. It is selective perception working for an active model.

Second, imagery can rehearse action-relevant systems. Kinesthetic imagery training has been associated with changes in neural signals and increased strength [Yao et al., 2013]. The careful conclusion is that imagery can prepare part of the controller used in action. It does not replace physical training. Effective visualization therefore includes the process, the obstacle, and the response, not only the pleasure of completion.

Third, expectation can become physiology. Placebo research has connected expectation to dopamine release in Parkinson’s disease and to measurable changes in pain-related brain activity [de la Fuente-Fernández et al., 2001, Wager et al., 2004]. These findings do not show that belief can cure every illness. They establish the narrower and important point that meaning can become a biological input.

Fourth, implementation intentions convert general desire into executable policy. An if-then rule specifies a cue and a response: *if situation X occurs, I will perform action A*. Research on implementation intentions shows why a prepared response can outperform intention alone [Sheeran et al., 2005]. The image supplies orientation; the rule supplies operational grammar.

State changes possibility

Sleep deprivation impairs decisions that require updating from feedback [Whitney et al., 2015]. Circadian misalignment changes performance in task-dependent ways [Chellappa et al., 2018]. Metabolic state can alter decisions under risk [Symmonds et al., 2010]. Mild dehydration has been associated with changes in mood and cognition [Ganio et al., 2011, Armstrong et al., 2012]. Experimental immune activation can change neurobehavioral function [Grigoleit et al., 2011]. These are not excuses for every failed choice. They show that the chooser cannot be modeled apart from the state in which choosing occurs.

Food is part of this state architecture. In a randomized inpatient trial, an ultra-processed diet caused higher energy intake and weight gain than a minimally processed diet offered under matched conditions [Hall et al., 2019]. Interventions involving the gut microbiome have produced changes in reported emotional and neural measures, although results are specific to the intervention and population [Bagga et al., 2018]. Nutrition influences agency through metabolic, endocrine, immune, and neural pathways. No quantum explanation is needed.

The body is the alchemical vessel because it determines which intentions can survive contact with a moment. A dream held by an exhausted person and the same dream held by a rested, trained, and regulated person are the same as representations but different as causes. The biology does not dictate the destiny. It changes the policies that can be generated, selected, and executed reliably.

4 The Mathematics of Materialization

Let I_t denote an imaginal target at time t , B_t the agent’s embodied state, E_t the environment, π_t a policy, and W_{t+1} the later material world state. Let $\Pi(B_t, E_t)$ be the set of policies available to this agent in this state and environment. The materialization operator is:

$$P(W_{t+1} \mid I_t, B_t, E_t) = \sum_{\pi \in \Pi(B_t, E_t)} P(W_{t+1} \mid \text{do}(\pi), B_t, E_t) P(\pi \mid I_t, B_t, E_t). \quad (2)$$

The first term inside the sum describes what follows if policy π is executed. The second describes how the imaginal form, embodied state, and environment weight the selection of that policy. Consciousness changes the material future when it changes these weights, the available policy set, the quality of execution, or the interpretation of feedback.

Mediation

Theorem 4.1 (Mediation theorem). *Fix B_t and E_t . If two imaginal states i_1 and i_2 produce the same policy distribution,*

$$P(\pi \mid I_t = i_1, B_t, E_t) = P(\pi \mid I_t = i_2, B_t, E_t)$$

for every π , then they produce the same distribution of later material states:

$$P(W_{t+1} \mid I_t = i_1, B_t, E_t) = P(W_{t+1} \mid I_t = i_2, B_t, E_t).$$

Proof. Apply Equation 2 to i_1 and i_2 . The interventional outcome term is unchanged because policy, body, and environment are fixed. The policy weights are equal by assumption. The sums are therefore equal. $\square$

The theorem states the boundary of ordinary manifestation. If visualization changes neither attention, physiology, policy, action, nor any other mediator, the model predicts no external effect. A reliable effect on a shielded external system after every ordinary mediator was controlled would falsify the graph and require a new edge. The theory does not define such evidence away. It states what evidence must show.

Reachable futures

For reliability threshold ρ , let $\Pi_\rho(B, E)$ contain the policies the agent can execute with reliability at least ρ . For outcome threshold ϵ , define:

$$\mathcal{R}_{\epsilon, \rho}(B, E) = \{w : \exists \pi \in \Pi_\rho(B, E) \text{ such that } P(w \mid \text{do}(\pi), B, E) \geq \epsilon\}. \quad (3)$$

Theorem 4.2 (Reachable-future theorem). *Let B^+ and B^- be embodied states in the same environment. If*

$$\Pi_\rho(B^-, E) \subseteq \Pi_\rho(B^+, E),$$

and each outcome reachable under B^- remains at least as likely under the same policy in B^+ , then

$$\mathcal{R}_{\epsilon, \rho}(B^-, E) \subseteq \mathcal{R}_{\epsilon, \rho}(B^+, E).$$

The inclusion is strict if an additional reliable policy in B^+ reaches a new qualifying outcome.

Proof. Take any $w \in \mathcal{R}_{\epsilon, \rho}(B^-, E)$. By definition, some policy in $\Pi_\rho(B^-, E)$ reaches w at the required probability. Set inclusion makes the same policy available in B^+ , and the probability assumption preserves the threshold. Thus $w \in \mathcal{R}_{\epsilon, \rho}(B^+, E)$. An additional policy that reaches a new qualifying outcome makes the inclusion strict. $\square$

The theorem formalizes why embodiment changes reality access. If exhaustion removes the reliable policy *have the difficult conversation calmly*, one relational future disappears for that moment. If training adds the reliable policy *build and deploy the prototype*, a previously imaginary future becomes reachable. Capacity does not guarantee an outcome. It changes the set of outcomes with credible paths.

Identity convergence

Let Z_t be a vector representing enacted identity at time t , and let U_t represent the identity evidence supplied by behavior at that time. Consider the update rule

$$Z_{t+1} = (1 - \alpha)Z_t + \alpha U_t, \quad 0 < \alpha \leq 1. \quad (4)$$

The rule is a model, not a proposed biological law. It captures the idea that people partly infer who they are from what they repeatedly do [Bem, 1972, Oyserman, 2009].

Theorem 4.3 (Identity-convergence theorem). *If an agent repeatedly supplies identity-consistent evidence $U_t = z^*$, then after k updates,*

$$Z_{t+k} = z^* + (1 - \alpha)^k (Z_t - z^*),$$

and therefore $Z_{t+k} \rightarrow z^$ as $k \rightarrow \infty$.*

Proof. Substitute $U_t = z^*$ into Equation 4 and subtract z^* from both sides:

$$Z_{t+1} - z^* = (1 - \alpha)(Z_t - z^*).$$

Iterating k times gives the stated expression. Since $0 \leq 1 - \alpha < 1$, the remaining difference converges to zero. $\square$

This is the formal meaning of *play the part until you become the part*. Costume alone does not cause convergence. Repeated identity-consistent evidence does. A person becomes a writer by writing, a builder by building, a leader by taking responsibility, and a contemplative by returning attention to practice. The internal identity and the external record begin to agree.

Directed repetition

Theorem 4.4 (Repetition theorem). *Suppose attempt t succeeds with conditional probability*

$$p_t = P(\text{success at } t \mid \text{all previous attempts failed}).$$

Then the probability of at least one success by attempt n is

$$P(\text{success by } n) = 1 - \prod_{t=1}^n (1 - p_t).$$

Adding an attempt with $p_{n+1} > 0$, or increasing any p_t , strictly increases the cumulative probability.

Proof. By the chain rule, the probability that every attempt fails is $\prod_{t=1}^n (1 - p_t)$. Its complement is at least one success. A new factor below one, or a reduction in any existing failure factor, reduces total failure probability. $\square$

The conditional form does not require independent attempts. Learning can change each p_t . A clear form can increase the number of directed attempts. Training can increase their quality. Feedback can improve later policies. What appears suddenly as manifestation is often the visible threshold of an accumulating process.

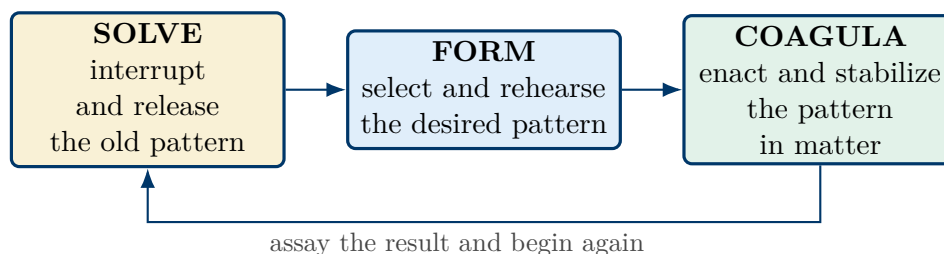


Figure 2: Solve et coagula as an operational cycle. Dissolution creates freedom; recombination gives the selected form persistence.

5 Solve et Coagula

The alchemical maxim *solve et coagula* means dissolve and recombine. It provides a compact grammar for transformation. The inherited pattern must become changeable before a chosen pattern can become stable.

Solve is the loosening of automatic structure. A person notices an inherited identity, interrupts a habit, leaves an environment, questions a belief, or permits an emotion to become conscious. The operation creates degrees of freedom. Without it, new intention is poured into an old mold.

Coagula is the stabilization of a selected form. A person rehearses a policy, changes a room, signs an agreement, builds a schedule, develops a skill, or creates an artifact. The operation gives the new pattern material persistence. Without it, insight evaporates.

The cycle explains why positive affirmation often fails. If the old context, cues, skills, rewards, and repeated actions remain untouched, the prior form keeps receiving material reinforcement. Words naming a new identity compete against a world proving the old one. Solve changes the constraint. Coagula makes the new claim true in observable increments.

The cycle also prevents endless dissolution. Insight, catharsis, altered states, and symbolic death can become another avoidance if they never produce form. Alchemy is completed by embodiment. The test is not how intense the release felt. The test is what pattern can now be sustained.

At larger scales, the same grammar builds institutions. A founder dissolves an assumption about how a service must work, models another arrangement, recruits people into the form, encodes it in software and contracts, and measures whether the new institution performs. Social reality is material reality organized partly by shared symbols. A contract, company, currency, and role exist because representations are coordinated and repeatedly enacted, yet their consequences are physically real.

6 Inner Alchemy

Traditional systems described human transformation before psychology had its current vocabulary. Their symbols should neither be flattened into laboratory claims nor discarded as meaningless. They can be read as maps of the Great Work at different levels.

Hermetic and psychological alchemy

Hermetic texts place human knowledge within a living cosmos and join transformation of the knower to knowledge of the whole [Copenhaver, 1992]. Later alchemical imagery describes separation, purification, conjunction, death, and rebirth. Jung read this imagery as projection and discovery of psychic transformation [Jung, 1968]. In the language developed here, the material and psychological readings share a structure: an initial form is broken apart, its elements are reorganized, and a more integrated form is stabilized.

The gold symbolizes incorruptible value, but symbolic gold does not excuse the work. An integrated self must become visible as integrated conduct. If the practitioner claims wholeness while remaining governed by the same compulsions, the assay has failed. Inner alchemy is accountable to the life it produces.

Kundalini and sacred secretion

Kundalini traditions describe concentrated practice, ascending energy, centers of transformation, and altered consciousness [Bühnemann, 2011, White, 1996]. Contemporary reports describe powerful experiences and lasting effects, although much of the evidence is phenomenological [Woollacott et al., 2021]. These traditions can be read as an inner alchemical map: dormant potential is activated, disciplined, raised, integrated, and expressed as a transformed mode of being.

The sacred-secretion thesis extends the same pattern through a Christian and bodily symbolism of descent, preservation, ascent, death, and rebirth [Edgar, 2026]. As comparative symbolism, the synthesis is coherent. It links the alchemical vessel, the spinal axis, anointing, resurrection, and the birth of a higher identity. It also gives practice a rhythm: receive, conserve, transform, and embody.

The anatomical claim must be stated separately. Known cerebrospinal-fluid and pineal physiology does not establish one universal monthly substance that descends from the brain to the sacrum and returns [Hladky and Barrand, 2014, Nichols, 2018]. Mammalian brains contain enzymatic machinery related to DMT biosynthesis, but that finding does not establish the popular cycle or its theological meaning [Dean et al., 2019]. A symbolic map can organize experience and conduct without being mislabeled as settled anatomy.

Theosis and Christ consciousness

Christian theosis concerns participation in divine life and transformation into likeness with God [Athanasius of Alexandria, 2011, Papanikolaou, 2020]. In the present theory, the image of divine humanity functions as the highest regulative form. It reorganizes attention, sacrifice, forgiveness, courage, love, and service. “Christ consciousness” is a modern name for this orientation when it is treated as a lived identity rather than a laboratory variable.

The phrase *we are God* can then be handled with care. It need not mean that an individual ego controls every event. It can mean that conscious beings participate in creation: they receive form, exercise choice, generate value, and become responsible for what passes through them into the world. Theosis adds an ethical criterion. Power without truth, love, and service is not divinization. It is inflation.

Alchemy, kundalini, sacred secretion, and theosis are not historically identical. Their physiology and theology should not be merged by assertion. Their functional pattern nevertheless converges:

higher form $\rightarrow$ disciplined vessel $\rightarrow$ transformed identity $\rightarrow$ transformed conduct. (5)

Science can test the mediators. Symbol and theology address the meaning of the work.

7 Technological Alchemy

Modern institutions often translate ancient operations into technical language. They replace initiation with protocol, ritual sound with engineered audio, contemplation with state induction, and spiritual maps with diagrams. Two supplied primary records show how claims about consciousness and fields entered formal technical channels.

Gateway as an engineered transformation system

The 1983 Department of the Army memorandum *Analysis and Assessment of Gateway Process* was written by Wayne M. McDonnell and later released in the CIA Reading Room [McDonnell, 1983]. It is frequently called a CIA report, but the document identifies an Army origin. CIA custody establishes archive provenance, not CIA authorship.

The memorandum analyzes the Monroe Institute’s Gateway system through hypnosis, biofeedback, transcendental meditation, kundalini, Hemi-Sync audio, the frequency-following response, visualization, and what it calls patterning. It describes biofeedback as using a desired result, objective response data, repeated correction, and reinforcement. It describes Hemi-Sync as a method intended to coordinate the hemispheres and uses coherence metaphors to explain focused consciousness. Its practical sequence is recognizably alchemical:

induce state $\rightarrow$ focus form $\rightarrow$ rehearse pattern $\rightarrow$ receive feedback $\rightarrow$ stabilize capacity.

Gateway is therefore legitimately read as technological alchemy. It attempts to engineer and accelerate states that older traditions approached through ritual, breath, concentration, ascetic discipline, and initiation. It is valuable evidence that a formal military organization considered the subject worth analysis and proposed further experiments.

The documentary boundary is equally important. The memorandum combines established phenomena, theoretical analogy, and speculative cosmology. Its conclusion recommends testing and often reasons conditionally about what would follow if the framework were valid. It is not a completed controlled trial of remote viewing, astral travel, or direct materialization. Institutional inquiry is not experimental confirmation.

The monitor-field patent

U.S. Patent 6,506,148 B2, *Nervous System Manipulation by Electromagnetic Fields from Monitors*, describes a proposed method using pulsed monitor fields in the 0.1–15 Hz range [Loos, 2003]. Its specification relies substantially on subject-controlled tuning and subjective responses. Separate neuroscience shows that visual systems can entrain to video displays under

defined conditions [Williams et al., 2004]. This makes the broad category of stimulus-linked neural response scientifically intelligible.

A patent grant, however, is a legal event. It establishes the disclosed claim, priority, and examination under patent law. The USPTO utility requirement is not a blinded clinical-efficacy standard [United States Patent and Trademark Office, 2026]. The patent is strong evidence that the method was formally claimed and granted. It is not independent, multi-participant replication of every effect described in the specification.

The alchemical relevance is not that the patent proves hidden control. It shows that the vessel can be approached as a system whose state is influenced by patterned sensory and electromagnetic input. This makes environmental design part of practical alchemy. It does not establish that a monitor can insert arbitrary semantic content into a person or that all screens are covertly using the claimed method.

DNA, fields, and quantum claims

DNA is genetic material, a regulated polymer, and a medium through which charge transport can occur [Crick, 1970, Virolainen et al., 2023, Zwang et al., 2018]. Calling it either a code or an antenna creates a false choice. It has informational, chemical, mechanical, and electrical properties. The stronger claim that spoken words semantically reprogram DNA has not been established by blinded, independent, multilaboratory replication. Literature sympathetic to a DNA “phantom effect” itself records the replication problem [Gariaev et al., 2011, Brill, 2012].

The heart produces measurable electrical and magnetic activity. Magnetocardiography detects cardiac fields in the picotesla range [Roth, 2024]. A measurable field is not automatically an intention broadcast, and measurement does not establish a privileged three-foot consciousness boundary. The disciplined alchemical claim is simpler: cardiac state, breathing, arousal, and felt emotion are part of the embodied realm and can influence policy.

Quantum tunneling occurs in enzyme reactions, and quantum coherence has been studied in photosynthetic systems [Cha et al., 1989, Panitchayangkoon et al., 2010]. There is active disagreement about which forms of coherence biology uses [Duan et al., 2017]. Quantum-consciousness proposals exist [Hameroff and Penrose, 2014], while decoherence calculations identify serious scale constraints for simple macroscopic accounts [Tegmark, 2000]. The many-worlds interpretation is an interpretation of quantum mechanics, not a demonstrated interface for choosing a desired personal timeline [Vaidman, 2022].

Quantum language can remain an analogy for a field of possibilities, but the formal theory does not depend on it. A choice already selects one action from many possible actions. That selection changes the next state of the world. Human timeline selection is causally real at the level of policy and consequence without claiming voluntary control over quantum branches.

8 The Counter-Alchemical Environment

If alchemy requires stable attention, embodied capacity, chosen identity, and repeated action, then an environment that fragments those capacities is counter-alchemical in effect. It dissolves the practitioner without allowing a chosen form to coagulate.

Phone notifications produce measurable attentional costs even when the user does not respond [Stothart et al., 2015, Upshaw et al., 2022]. Habits are linked to recurring contexts, and context changes can disrupt them [Wood et al., 2005, Wood and R  nger, 2016]. Recommendation systems are explicitly optimized to decide what a user sees next [Covington et al., 2016]. The resulting environment continuously supplies cues, identities, desires, and emotional frames. Attention that is always externally reset cannot hold a form long enough to build it.

Ultra-processed food, sleep disruption, outrage, pornography, compulsive consumption, and endless novelty can all become forms of interference when they repeatedly reduce regulation or replace chosen action. The relevant claim is not that one hidden group designed every product to suppress human divinity. The documented incentives are enough. Systems optimized for engagement, consumption, and short-term revenue can profit from behavior that conflicts with a person’s long-term intention.

The same distinction applies to degeneracy. The term is useful only when defined as a loss of ordered capacity: a pattern in which immediate reward repeatedly defeats truth, health, responsibility, creation, or care. Moral panic is not a mechanism. Repeated cue-driven behavior is. A person becomes whatever pattern receives the most consistent enactment and reinforcement.

This is why default settings matter. A default is a policy selected before reflective choice enters. It can be encoded in an application, a kitchen, a workplace, a peer group, or a self-story. Defaults conserve energy, but they also reproduce the reality of whoever designed them. Practical alchemy begins by asking which forms the current environment is already materializing through the person.

Resistance is concrete. Protect periods without incoming cues. Put the desired tool where action begins. Remove the trigger for the competing identity. Make sleep and food part of the operating system. Choose relationships that reinforce truth rather than performance. Treat information as nutrition. These changes do not withdraw from the physical world. They recover the capacity to act within it deliberately.

The traditional language of coherence can be retained if it is defined. Coherence is alignment among represented form, embodied state, identity, policy, and conduct. “Frequency” is literal only when a rate is measured; in personal practice it is better treated as a metaphor for a repeated pattern. The operative variable is not a vague vibration. It is whether the same organizing form persists across thought, body, choice, and action.

9 The Great Work

The Great Work is the complete practice of materialization. It turns the theory into a repeatable discipline.

1. Name the form. State the desired reality as an observable condition. “Become successful” is not yet a form. “Complete the manuscript, publish the repository, place the PDF in the portfolio, and obtain independent review” is. A physical criterion prevents a feeling of completion from replacing completion.

2. Assay the present reality. Record the current state without shame or inflation. Identify the existing evidence, skills, resources, constraints, habits, and missing conditions. Alchemy begins with prima materia, not with denial. A target becomes useful when the distance from the present can be described.

3. Solve the inherited pattern. Find the cue, identity, belief, relationship, or environment that reliably reproduces the unwanted form. Interrupt it at its point of operation. Reduce friction only for the chosen pattern. Dissolution should create a specific degree of freedom.

4. Visualize outcome, process, and identity. Represent the finished state vividly, then rehearse the process that creates it. Include the difficult conversation, the repetition, the rejection, the recovery, and the next attempt. Imagine from the first-person position of the one who performs those actions. Outcome imagery gives direction. Process imagery prepares the controller. Identity imagery gives the action personal meaning.

5. Encode the policy. Translate the image into an if-then rule for the decisive moment: *if it is 7:00 a.m., I open the manuscript before messages; if a submission is rejected, I record the reason and make the next submission within twenty-four hours.* This moves choice from a future depleted state into a present reflective state.

6. Prepare the vessel. Protect sleep, regular timing, adequate nutrition, hydration, movement, and recovery. Seek clinical care when symptoms require it. Use contemplative practice to notice automaticity and stabilize attention. Meditation research supports effects on selected measures of regulation, default-mode activity, and, in specific settings, transcriptional response [Brewer et al., 2011, Vago and Silbersweig, 2012, Black et al., 2013]. None of this guarantees an external result. It prepares the agent who must meet the next choice.

7. Enact and coagulate. Create a physical trace in every cycle: a page, call, prototype, application, workout, conversation, contract, or transfer of resources. Make the new reality easier to repeat. Schedule it, automate it, publish it, teach it, or place it in a structure that survives mood. Evidence tells both the person and the world that the identity is no longer merely imagined.

8. Assay, learn, and repeat. Compare the result with the target. Keep the form stable enough to guide action and flexible enough to learn. Update the policy, not merely the affirmation. A failed attempt is information if it changes the next attempt. Repetition without assay is compulsion. Repetition with assay is craft.

The practice can be summarized as:

$$\boxed{\text{clear form} \times \text{capable vessel} \times \text{effective policy} \times \text{repetition} \times \text{feedback}} \quad (6)$$

The multiplication sign is conceptual. If any term approaches zero, materialization weakens. The form can be vivid while the policy is absent. The policy can be sound while the vessel cannot execute it. Repetition can be intense while feedback is ignored. The Work aligns all five.

This protocol explains why manifestation can feel synchronistic without requiring that every coincidence was externally arranged. A held form changes what is noticed, which people are approached, which risks are tolerated, which skills are practiced, and how quickly an opportunity is recognized. The environment then responds to a different pattern of action. Some events remain chance. Others are the delayed return of causes the practitioner no longer remembers initiating.

10 Become the Part

The final operation is identity. A person can perform a role briefly through force, but sustained materialization requires the role to become a stable source of policy. This is not pretending that evidence already exists. It is generating the evidence from which a new self can truthfully be inferred.

To “act as if” responsibly means to enact the virtues and policies of the desired identity now, within present constraints. The future founder can make one accountable decision. The future athlete can complete today’s training. The future author can produce the page. Each action is small compared with the completed identity, but it is made of the same form. The part is first rehearsed, then evidenced, then inhabited.

Identity-based motivation research argues that accessible identities carry readiness for identity-congruent action and ways of interpreting difficulty [Oyserman, 2009]. Habit research shows how repeated responses in recurring contexts become efficient defaults [Wood and R  nger, 2016]. Self-perception theory explains why behavior can also become information about the self [Bem, 1972]. Together they provide a grounded mechanism for the ancient intuition: what is repeatedly enacted enters character.

The process is reciprocal:

$$\text{identity} \rightarrow \text{action} \rightarrow \text{evidence} \rightarrow \text{updated identity} \rightarrow \text{new action}. \quad (7)$$

This loop can build courage or addiction, service or vanity, creative power or learned helplessness. The law is neutral. Ethics determines the form worth stabilizing.

Falsifiable consequences

A formal theory should risk failure. The following predictions distinguish embodied alchemy from unfalsifiable wishing.

Prediction 1. Process visualization combined with implementation intentions will outperform outcome visualization alone on externally scored goals. Action frequency and execution quality will mediate the advantage.

Prediction 2. Repeated identity-consistent behavior will predict later self-description and identity-congruent choice more strongly when the behavior is voluntary, observable, and performed in a stable context.

Prediction 3. Restoring sleep and reducing interruption in disrupted participants will improve feedback updating and execution reliability, thereby increasing the number of reachable task outcomes.

Prediction 4. Prospective action histories will explain many apparently sudden manifestations better than outcome imagery alone. Apparent breakthroughs will often follow accumulating attempts, skill, and social feedback.

Prediction 5. Semantic DNA programming will fail blinded multilaboratory testing unless a meaning-specific effect survives energy matching, translation, sham exposure, and open raw-data review.

Prediction 6. Contemplative practice will change selected measures of attention, regulation, and self-transcendent experience through measurable mediators, but will not reliably alter shielded random physical outcomes.

Conclusion

Human beings are alchemical beings. They can receive a form that does not yet exist, hold it against the pressure of the present, reorganize themselves around it, and apply directed force until some part of the world takes its shape. This power is neither unlimited nor imaginary. It is bounded creation.

The mental and astral vision descends into the physical realm by acquiring embodiment, policy, action, and persistence. Consciousness supplies direction. The body supplies capacity. Identity supplies continuity. Action supplies physical force. Feedback supplies truth. Repetition supplies time.

The patent and Gateway memorandum matter because they show that unusual claims about fields and consciousness entered legal and institutional analysis. They deserve direct reading, not mythology. Their existence does not prove every proposed mechanism. Likewise, kundalini, sacred secretion, alchemy, and Christ consciousness preserve powerful architectures of transformation. Their symbolic convergence does not make every anatomical detail identical or experimentally established.

The disciplined thesis is stronger than exaggeration. Consciousness participates in creating reality because a represented future can become an organizing cause in the present. The person who repeatedly gives that form a body, a policy, an action, and an artifact becomes increasingly continuous with it. One plays the part, produces the evidence, and becomes the part.

Alchemy is therefore not the denial of matter. It is the education of matter by form through a conscious and embodied life. The Great Work is to choose the form carefully, prepare the vessel honestly, act without illusion, and continue until the world contains what once existed only in consciousness.

References

Lawrence E. Armstrong, Matthew S. Ganio, Douglas J. Casa, Elaine C. Lee, Brendon P. McDermott, Jennifer F. Klau, Liliana Jimenez, Laurent Le Bellego, Emmanuel Chevillotte, and Harris R. Lieberman. Mild dehydration affects mood in healthy young women. *Journal of Nutrition*, 142(2):382–388, 2012. doi: 10.3945/jn.111.142000.

- Athanasius of Alexandria. *On the Incarnation*. St Vladimir’s Seminary Press, Yonkers, New York, 2011.
- Deepika Bagga, Johanna Louise Reichert, Karl Koschutnig, Christoph Stefan Aigner, Peter Holzer, Kaisa Koskinen, Christine Moissl-Eichinger, and Veronika Schöpf. Probiotics drive gut microbiome triggering emotional brain signatures. *Gut Microbes*, 9(6):486–496, 2018. doi: 10.1080/19490976.2018.1460015.
- Daryl J. Bem. Self-perception theory. In Leonard Berkowitz, editor, *Advances in Experimental Social Psychology*, volume 6, pages 1–62. Academic Press, New York, 1972. doi: 10.1016/S0065-2601(08)60024-6.
- David S. Black, Steve W. Cole, Michael R. Irwin, Elizabeth Breen, Natalie M. St. Cyr, Nora Nazarian, Dharma S. Khalsa, and Helen Lavretsky. Yogic meditation reverses NF- κ B and IRF-related transcriptome dynamics in leukocytes of family dementia caregivers in a randomized controlled trial. *Psychoneuroendocrinology*, 38(3):348–355, 2013. doi: 10.1016/j.psyneuen.2012.06.011.
- Judson A. Brewer, Patrick D. Worhunsky, Jeremy R. Gray, Yi-Yuan Tang, Jochen Weber, and Hedy Kober. Meditation experience is associated with differences in default mode network activity and connectivity. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 108(50):20254–20259, 2011. doi: 10.1073/pnas.1112029108.
- Jason M. Brill. A proposal for inferential evidence of the DNA phantom effect. *DNA Decipher Journal*, 2(2):125–135, 2012. URL <https://dnadecipher.com/index.php/ddj/article/view/24>. The author states that the original effect had not, to his knowledge, been successfully replicated.
- Gudrun Bühnemann. The Saradatilakatantra on yoga: A new edition and translation of chapter 25. *Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies*, 74(2):205–235, 2011. doi: 10.1017/S0041977X11000036.
- Yuan Cha, Christopher J. Murray, and Judith P. Klinman. Hydrogen tunneling in enzyme reactions. *Science*, 243(4896):1325–1330, 1989. doi: 10.1126/science.2646716.
- Sarah L. Chellappa, Christopher J. Morris, and Frank A. J. L. Scheer. Daily circadian misalignment impairs human cognitive performance task-dependently. *Scientific Reports*, 8(1):3041, 2018. doi: 10.1038/s41598-018-20707-4.
- Brian P. Copenhaver. *Hermetica: The Greek Corpus Hermeticum and the Latin Asclepius in a New English Translation*. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 1992.
- Paul Covington, Jay Adams, and Emre Sargin. Deep neural networks for YouTube recommendations. In *Proceedings of the 10th ACM Conference on Recommender Systems*, pages 191–198, 2016. doi: 10.1145/2959100.2959190.
- Francis Crick. Central dogma of molecular biology. *Nature*, 227(5258):561–563, 1970. doi: 10.1038/227561a0.

- Raúl de la Fuente-Fernández, Thomas J. Ruth, Vesna Sossi, Michael Schulzer, Donald B. Calne, and A. Jon Stoessl. Expectation and dopamine release: Mechanism of the placebo effect in parkinson’s disease. *Science*, 293(5532):1164–1166, 2001. doi: 10.1126/science.1060937.
- Jon G. Dean, Tiecheng Liu, Sean Huff, Ben Sheler, Steven A. Barker, Rick J. Strassman, Michael M. Wang, and Jimo Borjigin. Biosynthesis and extracellular concentrations of N,N-dimethyltryptamine (DMT) in mammalian brain. *Scientific Reports*, 9(1):9333, 2019. doi: 10.1038/s41598-019-45812-w.
- Hong-Guang Duan, Valentyn I. Prokhorenko, Richard J. Cogdell, Khuram Ashraf, Amy L. Stevens, Michael Thorwart, and R. J. Dwayne Miller. Nature does not rely on long-lived electronic quantum coherence for photosynthetic energy transfer. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 114(32):8493–8498, 2017. doi: 10.1073/pnas.1702261114.
- Fallon Durant, Johanna Bischof, Chris Fields, Junji Morokuma, Joshua LaPalme, Alison Hoi, and Michael Levin. The role of early bioelectric signals in the regeneration of planarian anterior/posterior polarity. *Biophysical Journal*, 116(5):948–961, 2019. doi: 10.1016/j.bpj.2019.01.029.
- Daniel Ray Edgar. Human divinity: The sacred secretion as a cross-traditional model of transformation. Companion manuscript, 2026.
- Matthew S. Ganio, Lawrence E. Armstrong, Douglas J. Casa, Brendon P. McDermott, Elaine C. Lee, Linda M. Yamamoto, Stefania Marzano, Rebecca M. Lopez, Liliana Jimenez, Laurent Le Bellego, Emmanuel Chevillotte, and Harris R. Lieberman. Mild dehydration impairs cognitive performance and mood of men. *British Journal of Nutrition*, 106(10): 1535–1543, 2011. doi: 10.1017/S0007114511002005.
- Peter P. Gariaev, Alexander A. Kokaya, Irina V. Mukhina, Elizaveta A. Leonova-Gariaeva, Nina G. Kokaya, Olga A. Davydova, Sergey V. Tertichniy, and Alexander V. Tovmash. Principles of linguistic-wave genetics. *DNA Decipher Journal*, 1(1):11–24, 2011. URL <https://dnadecipher.com/index.php/ddj/article/view/4>.
- Jan-Sebastian Grigoleit, Jennifer S. Kullmann, Oliver T. Wolf, Florian Hammes, Alexander Wegner, Stephanie Jablonowski, Harald Engler, Elke Gizewski, Reiner Oberbeck, and Manfred Schedlowski. Dose-dependent effects of endotoxin on neurobehavioral functions in humans. *PLoS ONE*, 6(12):e28330, 2011. doi: 10.1371/journal.pone.0028330.
- Kevin D. Hall, Alexis Ayuketah, Robert Brychta, Hongyi Cai, Thomas Cassimatis, Kong Y. Chen, Stephanie T. Chung, Elise Costa, Amber Courville, Valerie Darcey, et al. Ultra-processed diets cause excess calorie intake and weight gain: An inpatient randomized controlled trial of ad libitum food intake. *Cell Metabolism*, 30(1):67–77.e3, 2019. doi: 10.1016/j.cmet.2019.05.008.
- Stuart Hameroff and Roger Penrose. Consciousness in the universe: A review of the “Orch OR” theory. *Physics of Life Reviews*, 11(1):39–78, 2014. doi: 10.1016/j.plrev.2013.08.002.
- Stephen B. Hladky and Margery A. Barrand. Mechanisms of fluid movement into, through and out of the brain: evaluation of the evidence. *Fluids and Barriers of the CNS*, 11(1):26, 2014. doi: 10.1186/2045-8118-11-26.

- William James. *The Varieties of Religious Experience*. Longmans, Green, and Co., New York, 1902.
- C. G. Jung. *Psychology and Alchemy*, volume 12 of *Collected Works of C. G. Jung*. Princeton University Press, Princeton, 2 edition, 1968.
- Eric R. Kandel, John D. Koester, Sarah H. Mack, and Steven A. Siegelbaum. *Principles of Neural Science*. McGraw Hill, New York, 6 edition, 2021. ISBN 9781259642234.
- Michael Levin. Bioelectric signaling: Reprogrammable circuits underlying embryogenesis, regeneration, and cancer. *Cell*, 184(8):1971–1989, 2021. doi: 10.1016/j.cell.2021.02.034.
- Hendricus G. Loos. Nervous system manipulation by electromagnetic fields from monitors. U.S. Patent 6,506,148 B2, January 2003. URL <https://patents.google.com/patent/US6506148B2/en>. Granted January 14, 2003.
- Wayne M. McDonnell. Analysis and assessment of gateway process. Department of the Army, U.S. Army Operational Group memorandum, June 1983. URL <https://www.cia.gov/readingroom/docs/CIA-RDP96-00788R001700210016-5.pdf>. Report CIA-RDP96-00788R001700210016-5, approved for release September 10, 2003.
- David E. Nichols. N,N-dimethyltryptamine and the pineal gland: Separating fact from myth. *Journal of Psychopharmacology*, 32(1):30–36, 2018. doi: 10.1177/0269881117736919.
- Daphna Oyserman. Identity-based motivation: Implications for action-readiness, procedural-readiness, and consumer behavior. *Journal of Consumer Psychology*, 19(3):250–260, 2009. doi: 10.1016/j.jcps.2009.05.008.
- Gitt Panitchayangkoon, Dugan Hayes, Kelly A. Fransted, Justin R. Caram, Elad Harel, Jianzhong Wen, Robert E. Blankenship, and Gregory S. Engel. Long-lived quantum coherence in photosynthetic complexes at physiological temperature. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 107(29):12766–12770, 2010. doi: 10.1073/pnas.1005484107.
- Aristotle Papanikolaou. Theosis. In Bernard McGinn and John Strawn, editors, *The Oxford Handbook of Mystical Theology*, pages 568–585. Oxford University Press, Oxford, 2020. doi: 10.1093/oxfordhb/9780198722380.013.29.
- Bradley J. Roth. The magnetocardiogram. *APL Bioengineering*, 8(2):021501, 2024. doi: 10.1063/5.0201950.
- Britton A. Sauerbrei and J. Andrew Pruszyński. The brain works at more than 10 bits per second. *Nature Neuroscience*, 28(7):1365–1366, 2025. doi: 10.1038/s41593-025-01997-0.
- Paschal Sheeran, Thomas L. Webb, and Peter M. Gollwitzer. The interplay between goal intentions and implementation intentions. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 31(1):87–98, 2005. doi: 10.1177/0146167204271308.
- Cary Stothart, Ainsley Mitchum, and Courtney Yehnert. The attentional cost of receiving a cell phone notification. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance*, 41(4):893–897, 2015. doi: 10.1037/xhp0000100.

- Mkael Symmonds, Julian J. Emmanuel, Megan E. Drew, Rachel L. Batterham, and Raymond J. Dolan. Metabolic state alters economic decision making under risk in humans. *PLoS ONE*, 5(6):e11090, 2010. doi: 10.1371/journal.pone.0011090.
- Max Tegmark. Importance of quantum decoherence in brain processes. *Physical Review E*, 61(4):4194–4206, 2000. doi: 10.1103/PhysRevE.61.4194.
- United States Patent and Trademark Office. Guidelines for examination of applications for compliance with the utility requirement. Manual of Patent Examining Procedure, Section 2107, 2026. URL <https://www.uspto.gov/web/offices/pac/mpep/s2107.html>.
- Joshua D. Upshaw, Carl E. Stevens, Giorgio Ganis, and Darya L. Zabelina. The hidden cost of a smartphone: The effects of smartphone notifications on cognitive control from a behavioral and electrophysiological perspective. *PLoS ONE*, 17(11):e0277220, 2022. doi: 10.1371/journal.pone.0277220.
- David R. Vago and David A. Silbersweig. Self-awareness, self-regulation, and self-transcendence (S-ART): a framework for understanding the neurobiological mechanisms of mindfulness. *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*, 6:296, 2012. doi: 10.3389/fnhum.2012.00296.
- Lev Vaidman. Many-worlds interpretation of quantum mechanics. The Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy, 2022. URL <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/qm-manyworlds/>. Fall 2022 edition.
- Samuel J. Virolainen, Andrew VonHandorf, Kenyatta C. M. F. Viel, Matthew T. Weirauch, and Leah C. Kottyan. Gene–environment interactions and their impact on human health. *Cellular and Molecular Life Sciences*, 80(1):1–11, 2023. doi: 10.1038/s41435-022-00192-6.
- Tor D. Wager, James K. Rilling, Edward E. Smith, Alex Sokolik, Kenneth L. Casey, Richard J. Davidson, Stephen M. Kosslyn, Robert M. Rose, and Jonathan D. Cohen. Placebo-induced changes in fMRI in the anticipation and experience of pain. *Science*, 303(5661):1162–1167, 2004. doi: 10.1126/science.1093065.
- David Gordon White. *The Alchemical Body: Siddha Traditions in Medieval India*. University of Chicago Press, Chicago, 1996.
- Paul Whitney, John M. Hinson, Melinda L. Jackson, and Hans P. A. Van Dongen. Feedback blunting: Total sleep deprivation impairs decision making that requires updating based on feedback. *Sleep*, 38(5):745–754, 2015. doi: 10.5665/sleep.4668.
- Patrick E. Williams, Ferenc Mechler, James Gordon, Robert Shapley, and Michael J. Hawken. Entrainment to video displays in primary visual cortex of macaque and humans. *Journal of Neuroscience*, 24(38):8278–8288, 2004. doi: 10.1523/JNEUROSCI.2716-04.2004.
- Wendy Wood and Dennis R  nger. Psychology of habit. *Annual Review of Psychology*, 67: 289–314, 2016. doi: 10.1146/annurev-psych-122414-033417.
- Wendy Wood, Leona Tam, and Melissa Guerrero Witt. Changing circumstances, disrupting habits. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 88(6):918–933, 2005. doi: 10.1037/0022-3514.88.6.918.

- Marjorie H. Woollacott, Yvonne Kason, and Russell D. Park. Investigation of the phenomenology, physiology and impact of spiritually transformative experiences: kundalini awakening. *Explore*, 17(6):525–534, 2021. doi: 10.1016/j.explore.2020.07.005.
- David Bryce Yaden, Jonathan Haidt, Ralph W. Hood, David R. Vago, and Andrew B. Newberg. The varieties of self-transcendent experience. *Review of General Psychology*, 21(2):143–160, 2017. doi: 10.1037/gpr0000102.
- Wan X. Yao, Vinoth K. Ranganathan, Didier Allexandre, Vloddek Siemionow, and Guang H. Yue. Kinesthetic imagery training of forceful muscle contractions increases brain signal and muscle strength. *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*, 7:561, 2013. doi: 10.3389/fnhum.2013.00561.
- Jieyu Zheng and Markus Meister. The unbearable slowness of being: Why do we live at 10 bits/s? *Neuron*, 113(2):192–204, 2025. doi: 10.1016/j.neuron.2024.11.008.
- Theodore J. Zwang, Edmund C. M. Tse, and Jacqueline K. Barton. Sensing DNA through DNA charge transport. *ACS Chemical Biology*, 13(7):1799–1809, 2018. doi: 10.1021/acscchembio.8b00347.